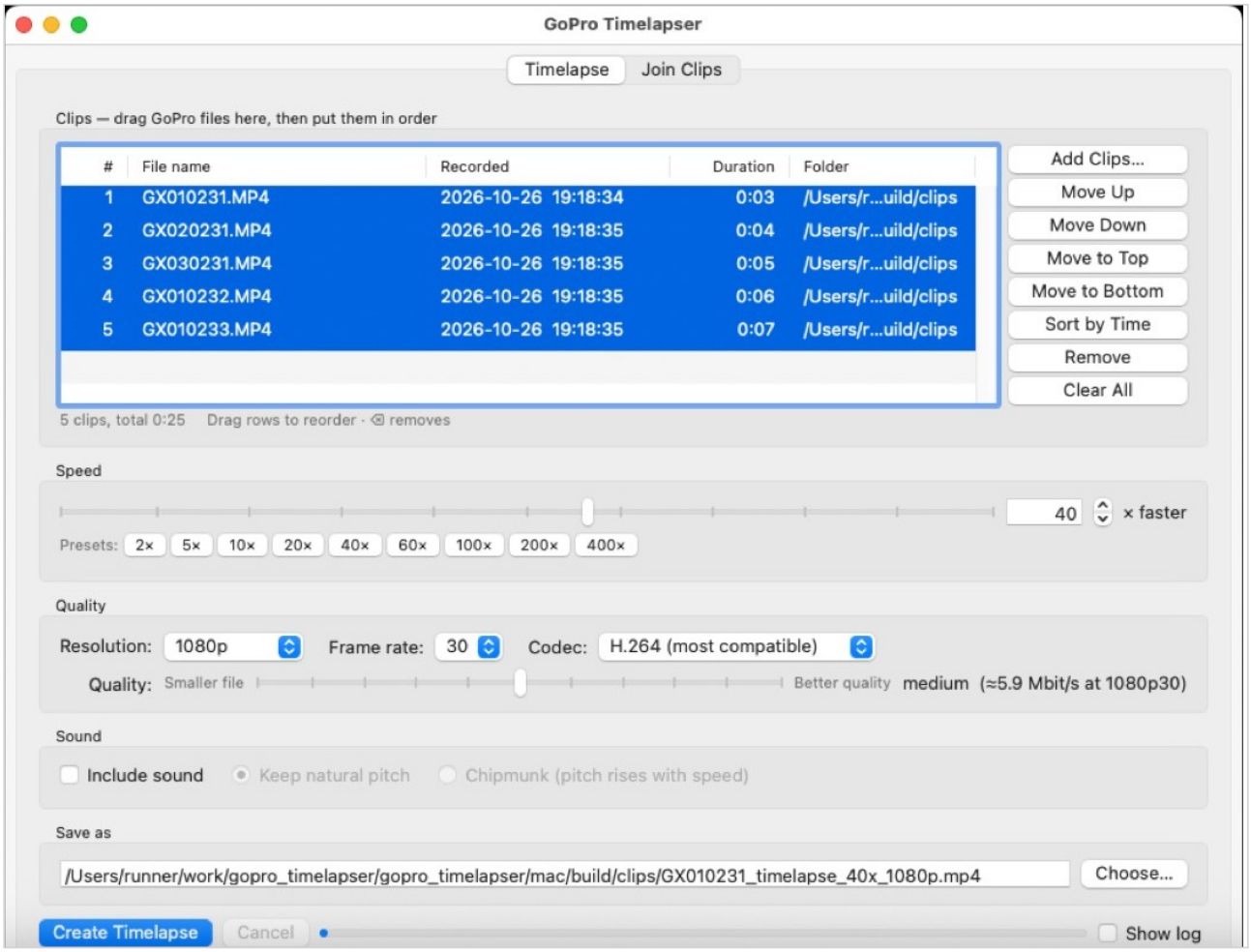
GoPro Timelapser

User guide for Mac: turning GoPro clips into timelapses, and joining clips together



In this guide

1. Installing and opening the app
2. Copying clips off the GoPro
3. Making a timelapse
4. Joining clips at normal speed
5. Tips for an older MacBook
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1. Installing and opening the app

GoPro Timelapser is a single app with nothing else to install. It works on any Mac running **macOS Catalina (10.15) or later**, including a 2016 MacBook. To check your version, click the Apple menu (the apple at the top-left of the screen) → **About This Mac**.

Installing

1. You will receive a file called **GoPro-Timelapser-mac.zip**. Double-click it to unzip it. You will get **GoPro Timelapser** (the app).
2. Drag **GoPro Timelapser** into your **Applications** folder.

Opening it the first time

Because the app doesn't come from the App Store, macOS asks you to confirm the first time you open it. You only need to do this once.

1. Open your **Applications** folder.
2. **Right-click** (or hold **Control** and click) **GoPro Timelapser**, then choose **Open**.
3. A message says the app is from an unidentified developer. Click **Open**.

From then on, open it like any other app: from Applications, Launchpad, or the Dock.

> **If macOS still won't open it:** open **System Preferences → Security & Privacy → General**. Near the bottom it says "GoPro Timelapser was blocked". Click **Open Anyway**, then **Open**.

> **Tip:** To keep the app in the Dock, right-click its Dock icon while it is open and choose **Options → Keep in Dock**.

2. Copying clips off the GoPro

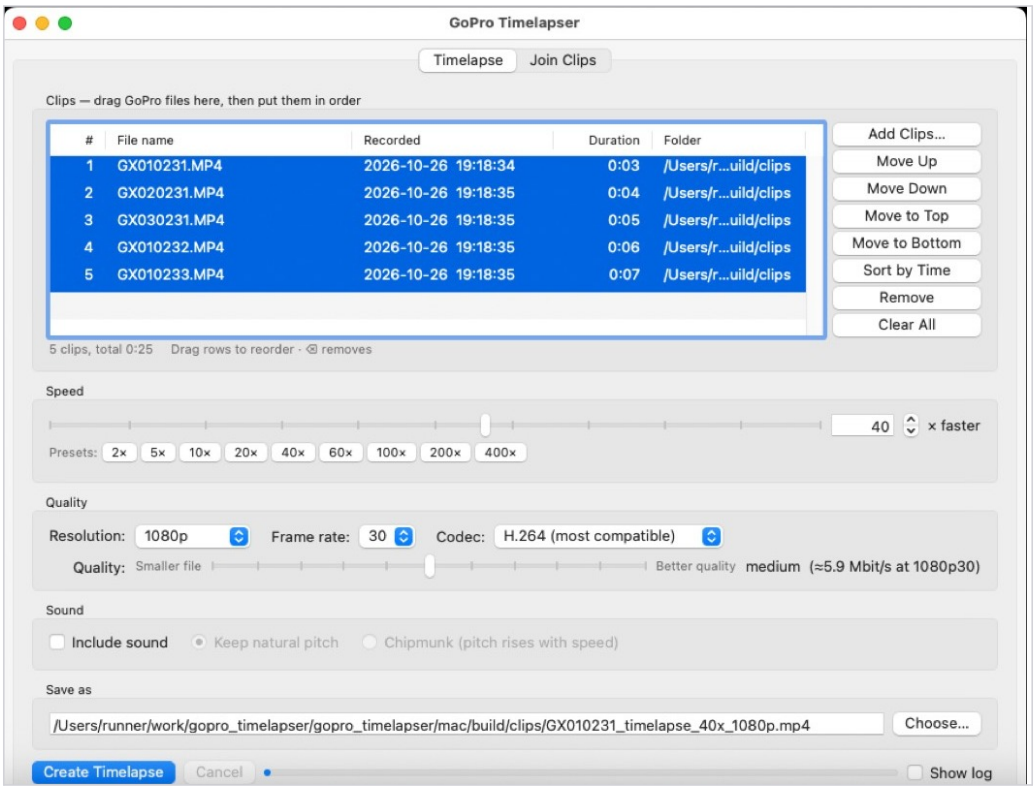
1. Put the GoPro's memory card in a card reader (or connect the camera with its USB cable).
2. In Finder, open the card and go to the **DCIM** folder, then **100GOPRO**.
3. Copy the **.MP4** files you want into a folder on the Mac, for example a new folder in **Movies**. Working from the Mac is faster than working from the card.

You can ignore the **.LRV** and **.THM** files. They are small preview files the camera makes for its own use.

> **About GoPro file names:** a long recording is split into several files called **chapters**. **GX01**0123.MP4, **GX02**0123.MP4, **GX03**0123.MP4 are parts 1, 2 and 3 of recording number **0123**. The app puts them in the right order for you.

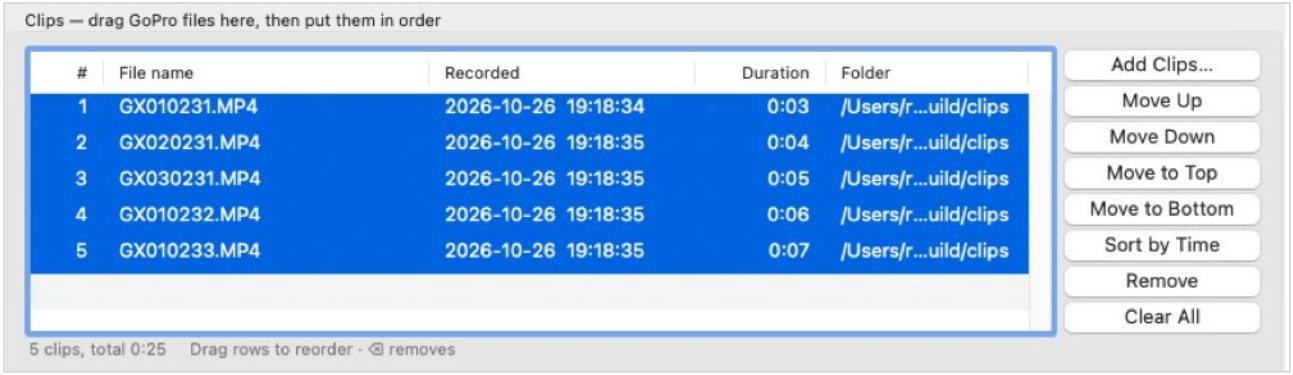
3. Making a timelapse

A timelapse speeds the footage up, so an hour-long drive or sunset plays back in a minute or two. The **Timelapse** tab at the top of the window does this. The window is laid out top to bottom in the order you use it.



The Timelapse tab

Step 1: Add your clips

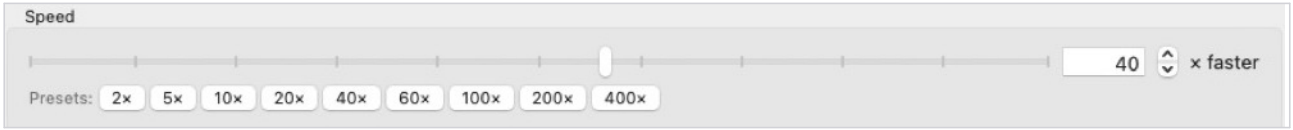


- **Drag** clips from Finder into the list. You can also drag a whole folder in.
- Or click **Add Clips…** and choose them.
- Each row shows the file name, when it was recorded, and how long it is. Below the list is the number of clips and their total length.
- Clips are sorted by recording time as you add them. To change the order, **drag a row up or down**, or select it and use the **Move Up** / **Move Down** / **Move to Top** / **Move to Bottom** buttons. **Sort by Time** puts everything back in recording order.

- To take a clip out, select it and press **Delete** (or click **Remove**). **Clear All** empties the list.

> **Tip:** To select several clips at once, hold ⌘ **Command** and click each one, or hold **Shift** and click the first and last of a range.

Step 2: Choose the speed



The speed is how many times faster than real life the timelapse plays. Drag the slider, type a number between **2** and **400**, or click one of the presets. Underneath, the app shows how long the finished timelapse will be.

Speed	1 hour of footage becomes	Good for
10×	6 minutes	Walks, gentle sped-up action
40×	1½ minutes	Drives, bike rides, hikes
100×	36 seconds	Long journeys, clouds
400×	9 seconds	Very long recordings, sunsets, all-day events

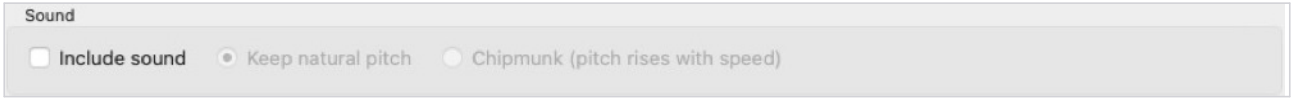
> **Tip:** Not sure? Start with **40×**, look at the result, then adjust.

Step 3: Choose the quality



- **Resolution**: the picture size. **1080p** (Full HD) is a good choice for watching on a laptop or TV and keeps files small. **Original** keeps the camera's own size. The app never makes the picture bigger than the camera recorded it.
- **Frame rate**: **30** is smooth and standard. Leave it unless you have a reason to change it.
- **Codec**: leave this on **H.264 (most compatible)**. HEVC makes smaller files but is **much slower on a 2016 MacBook**.
- **Quality slider**: move left for smaller files, right for a sharper picture. The middle ("medium") is fine for most things.

Step 4: Sound (optional)



Timelapses are normally silent. Tick **Include sound** to keep the clips' sound, sped up to match the video. Then choose how it should sound:

- **Keep natural pitch**: voices and sounds keep their normal pitch and play as quick snippets.
- **Chipmunk**: like fast-forwarding a tape; the pitch rises the faster you go.

Above about 40× the sound becomes a very short, choppy blur. That's expected at those speeds.

Step 5: Save and create



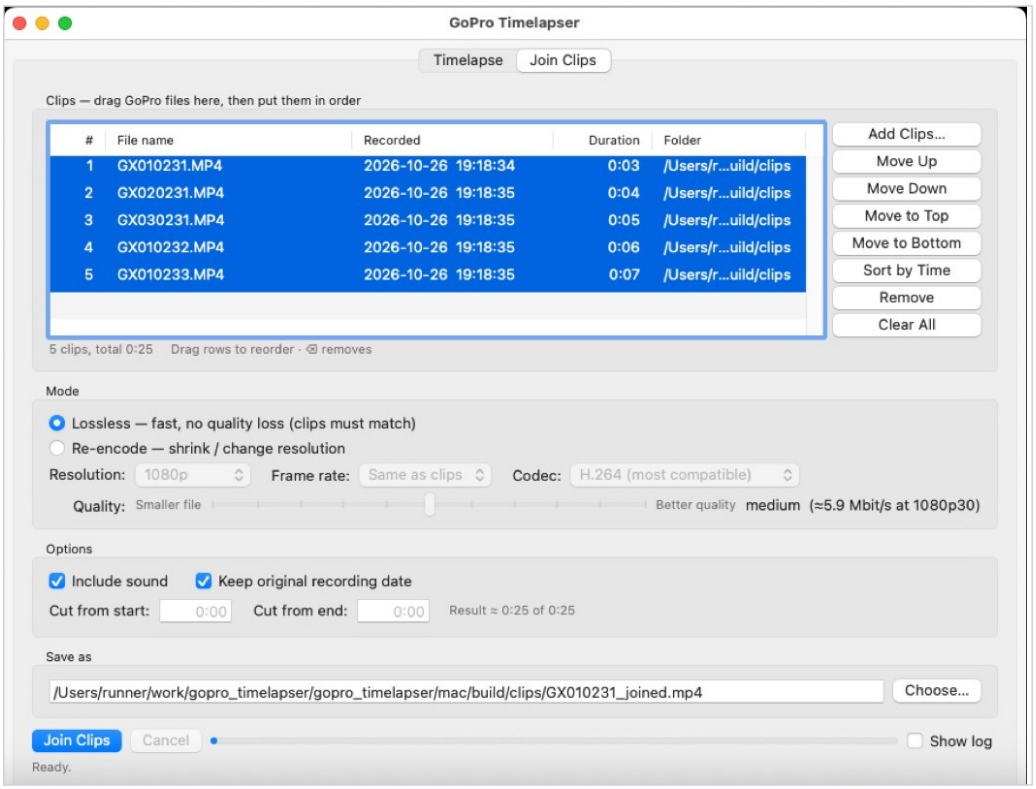
Under **Save as**, the app suggests a name in the same folder as your first clip, for example GX010231_timelapse_40x_1080p.mp4. Click **Choose…** to save it somewhere else or give it a different name.

Click **Create Timelapse**. The progress bar fills as it works, and the line underneath shows how far it has got and roughly how long is left. When it finishes, a message appears. Click **Show in Finder** to go straight to the new video.

> **Tip:** Changed your mind? Click **Cancel**. The unfinished file is deleted automatically.

4. Joining clips at normal speed

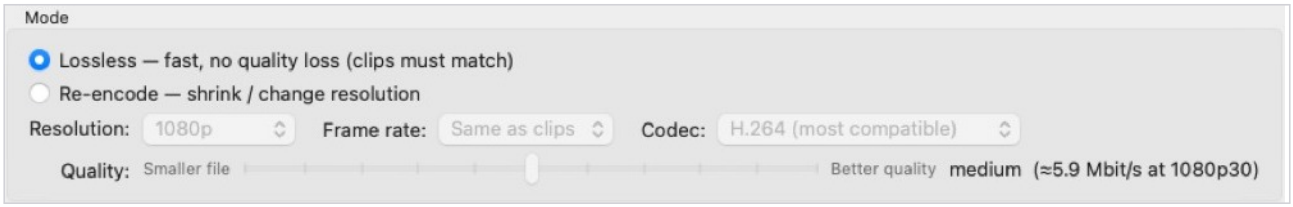
The **Join Clips** tab sticks clips together end to end into one video at normal speed. It is handy for putting a recording's chapters back into one file, or combining several clips from a day out. Click **Join Clips** at the top of the window to switch to it.



The Join Clips tab

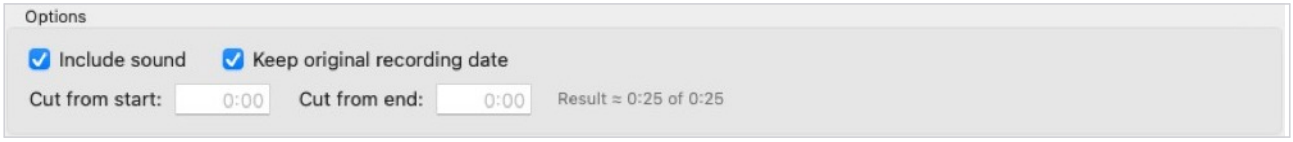
Add and order your clips exactly as on the Timelapse tab (see Step 1 above). Each tab has its own list.

Mode



- **Lossless** (recommended): copies the video exactly as the camera recorded it. It is very fast, usually just seconds, with **no loss of quality**. The clips must come from the same camera with the same settings, which chapters of one recording always do.
- **Re-encode**: makes a new, usually smaller video. Use it to **shrink** a big file, change the resolution, or join clips recorded with different settings. The quality controls work the same as on the Timelapse tab. **Frame rate: Same as clips** keeps the original smoothness. This is much slower than Lossless.

Options



- **Include sound**: untick to make a silent video.
- **Keep original recording date**: gives the new video the date and time the first clip was recorded, so it appears in the right place in Photos and when sorting in Finder. Leave this ticked.
- **Cut from start / Cut from end**: trims a little off the beginning or end, for example fiddling with the camera. Type seconds (**15**) or minutes:seconds (**1:30**). The app shows how long the result will be.

Save and join



Check the name under **Save as** (or click **Choose…**), then click **Join Clips**. A Lossless join usually finishes in seconds; Re-encode takes longer and shows its progress.

5. Tips for an older MacBook

A 2016 MacBook handles all of this, but video work keeps it busy. These help:

- **Plug in the charger** before starting a long timelapse.
- Keep **Codec** on **H.264**. Your MacBook has hardware for making H.264 video, but HEVC has to be done the slow way.
- **1080p** is much quicker than 4K and looks great on the MacBook's screen.
- Close other big apps (especially web browsers with many tabs) while it runs.
- Check you have enough **free space**. A Lossless join needs about as much space as the clips themselves. A timelapse is usually small: about 45 MB per minute at 1080p medium quality.
- The MacBook may get warm and its fan may run. That's normal while making video.
- Speed doesn't change how long a timelapse takes much, because the app still has to read through all the footage. Expect longer recordings to take a while; the progress line shows the time remaining.

> **Tip:** Try a short test first: add one or two clips, make a timelapse, and check you like the speed and quality before processing a whole day's footage.

6. If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
The app won’t open, or says it’s from an unidentified developer	Right-click the app and choose **Open**. See section 1, including **Open Anyway**.
“These clips can’t be joined losslessly”	The clips were recorded with different settings or cameras. Choose **Re-encode** on the Join Clips tab and try again.
A clip’s **Recorded** time is wrong	The time comes from the camera’s clock. Set the clock in the GoPro (or the GoPro Quik app) for future recordings, and put clips in order by dragging them.
Clips are in the wrong order	Drag rows up or down, or click **Sort by Time**.
The sound is choppy	Normal at high speeds. Try a lower speed or switch the sound off.
“Something went wrong” message	Tick **Show log** (bottom right) to see details. Check there is enough free disk space and that the clips play in QuickTime Player. If one clip is damaged, remove it and try again.
Can’t find the finished video	It is saved where **Save as** says, normally the same folder as your first clip. Click **Show in Finder** in the message that appears when it finishes.
It’s very slow	See section 5. Use H.264 and 1080p, plug in the charger, and close other apps.

Quick reference

To…	Do this
Add clips	Drag files or a folder into the list, or click **Add Clips…**
Reorder clips	Drag rows, or select and use the Move buttons
Remove a clip	Select it and press **Delete**
Select several clips	⌘ **Command**-click, or **Shift**-click a range
Stop a video being made	Click **Cancel**
See what the app is doing	Tick **Show log**
Quit	⌘ **Command + Q**